sequestration. Independently, biochar when added to soil can increase soil fertility of acidic soils, increase agricultural productivity, and provide protection against some foliar and soil borne diseases. It is a good method of preventing waste woods and logs from getting decayed and instead we can convert them into biochar thus converting them to carbon storage material.

8.8 Rain water harvesting – RWH (Solution to water crisis – A ecological problem)

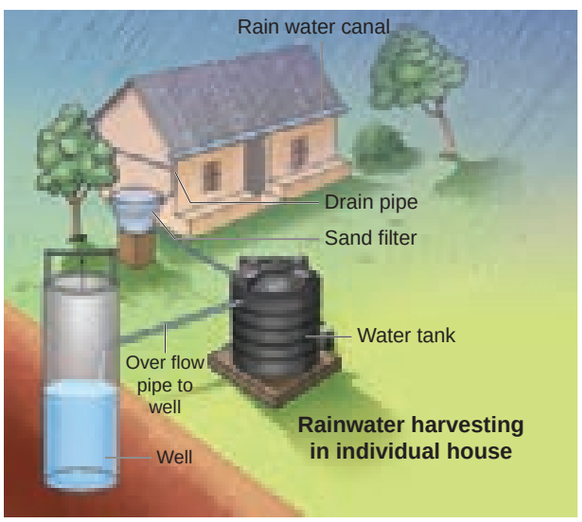


Figure 8.9: Pictures of Rain Water Harvesting Structures in Ooraniers

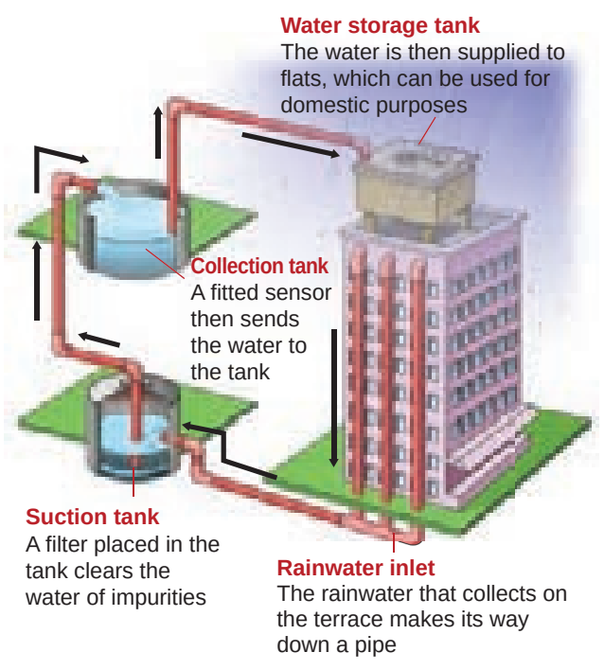


Figure 8.10: Rain Water Harvesting Structures in Water Supply sources

Rainwater harvesting is the accumulation and storage of rain water for reuse in-site rather than allowing it to run off. Rainwater can be collected from rivers, roof tops and the water collected is directed to a deep pit. The water percolates and gets stored in the pit. RWH is a sustainable water management practice implemented not only in urban area but also in agricultural fields, which is an important economical cost effective method for the future.

8.8.1 Environmental benefits of Rain Water Harvesting:

- Promotes adequacy of underground water and water conservation.
- Mitigates the effect of drought.
- Reduces soil erosion as surface run-off is reduced.
- Reduces flood hazards.
- Improves groundwater quality and water table / decreases salinity.
- Avoid land wastage for storage purpose and no population displacement is involved.
- Stores water underground as an eco-friendly measure and us a part of sustainable water storage strategy for local communities.

8.8.2 Importance of Lakes

Water bodies like lakes, ponds not only provide us a number of environmental benefits but they strengthen our economy as well as our quality of life like health. Lakes as a storage of rain water provide drinking water, improves ground water level and preserve the fresh water bio-diversity and habitat of the area where it occurs.

In terms of services lakes offer sustainable solutions to key issues of water management and climatic influences and benefits like nutrient retention, influencing local rainfall, removal of pollutants, phosphorous and nitrogen and carbon sequestration.

TN_GOVT_BIOLOGY-BOTANY_XII_PAGES_169-184 CH 08.indd 166 3/14/2020 11:48:22 AM